ỌGỤ ANỌ: War of the Four Market Days

Game Pitch Dossier · Version 1.0 · October 2026

Four days. One truth. No fifth.
Onye kwe, chi ya ekwe
"When a person says yes, their Chi says yes."

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Project status: Pre-production concept / contest prototype proposal
Genre: 2D narrative fighting game
Planned platforms: Android (primary), Windows PC
Proposed engine: Godot 4
Behance project: https://www.behance.net/gallery/257696843/g-An-War-of-the-Four-Market-Days?platform=direct

At a glance

ITEM	summary
Working title	Ọgụ Anọ: War of the Four Market Days
Genre	2D fighting game with narrative choices
Core audience	Fighting-game fans, African and diaspora audiences, and players interested in folklore-inspired worlds
Visual direction	Stylised 2D, hand-painted textures, "Uli in motion"
Signature systems	Market Clock, Chi Awakening, ỌfọVerdict
Planned modes	Story, versus, survival, training
Content target	Stylised fantasy combat without blood or gore
Development stage	Proposal; the complete game is not yet represented as built or released

1. The pitch

Logline

When a fallen priest-king steals the sacred Ọfọ and tears a lawless "Fifth Day" into the Igbo week, Adaeze, daughter of the Earth goddess Ala, must fight through a tournament of gods, ancestors and spirits to restore the Four Market Days---and the truth they protect.

THE ELEVATOR PITCH

Ọgụ Anọ is a story-driven 2D fighting game where the rhythm of the world changes the rhythm of combat. Inspired by Igbo cosmology, language and visual culture, it turns the four market days. Eke, Orie, Afọ and Nkwọ ---into a living combat system. Players master fighters with distinct abilities, adapt to a rotating Market Clock, awaken their personal Chi when a fight is on the line, and make a final choice

between Ebere (Mercy) and Ikpe (Judgement).

The result is a fighting game concept with a distinctive cultural foundation, readable competitive mechanics, and a story in which victory is not only about defeating an opponent---it is about deciding what justice should mean.

2. THE WORLD

In the world of Ọgụ Anọ, the four market days are more than a calendar. They represent a rhythm that orders trade, community, spiritual life and the balance between people and the unseen world.

The sacred Ọfọ, a symbol of truth and authority, is stolen by a fallen priest-king. In its absence, a forbidden Fifth Day begins to spread. Promises lose their weight, old boundaries weaken, and the balance between the living, ancestors and spirits begins to collapse.

Adaeze sets out to recover the Ọfọ. Her journey leads through village markets, sacred groves, lakeside shrines, masquerade grounds, midnight forests and the Palace of the Hollow King. Each battle reveals another part of the crisis---and asks what it means to restore order without simply repeating the violence that broke it.

STORY PILLARS

- **Balance and consequence:** every day has a role; every choice has a cost.
- **Chi and personal agency:** characters are shaped by destiny, but their decisions still matter.
- **Truth and accountability:** the Ọfọ is a symbol of authority that must be earned, not merely possessed.
- **Community and memory:** markets, ancestors, music, language and public gatherings shape the world.
- **Mercy versus judgement:** the ending responds to how the player treats defeated opponents.

3. THE PLAYER FANTASY

The player should feel like a skilled fighter learning to read a world that is alive around them. The Market Clock changes the strategic conditions of a match. Character affinities reward preparation. Chi Awakening creates a dramatic comeback opportunity. At the end of key encounters, the Ọfọ Verdict turns the win into a moral decision.

The intended experience is easy to understand, rewarding to master, visually expressive, and rooted in a specific cultural world rather than generic fantasy.

4. SIGNATURE GAMEPLAY SYSTEMS

THE MARKET CLOCK

A circular dial cycles through Eke, Orie, Afọ and Nkwọ, advancing every 10 seconds in the proposed design. Each day applies a global combat

effect; fighters whose affinity matches the active day receive an additional advantage. Players can spend one bar of Ọfọ meter to force the clock forward early.

Market day	Global effect	Matching-affinity bonus
Eke	Heavy attacks gain 10% damage and light armour	A further 10% damage and onearmour hit on heavy attacks
Orie	Movement and dash speed increase by 10%	One free cancel per combo
Afọ	Throws and feints execute 15% faster	Teleports and command grabs gain extra range
Nkwọ	Successful blocks recover meter	Counters deal 20% moredamage

These values are proposed design targets and should be validated through playtesting.

Chi Awakening

When a fighter is under pressure, their personal Chi can manifest as a short-lived power surge. The intended function is to create a dramatic comeback window without making a losing player automatically win. Timing, resource management and counterplay remain essential.

Ọfọ Verdict: Ebere or Ikpe

After selected battles, the player chooses:

- **Ebere --- Mercy**: spare the defeated opponent, potentially changing their later role or the outcome of the story.
- **Ikpe --- Judgement:** hold the opponent accountable, with consequences that may close off other possibilities.

The choice is intended to shape character outcomes and contribute to four planned endings, including a secret true ending.

Core match loop

1. Choose a fighter.
2. Enter a stage and adapt to the active Market Day.
3. Fight using light and heavy attacks, blocks, specials, combos and throws.
4. Win two of three rounds.
5. In story encounters, make an Ọfọ Verdict when prompted.
6. Unlock the next confrontation and learn more about the Fifth Day.

5. CHARACTER ROSTER

The full design proposes eight playable fighters and two major bosses. The roster below reflects the current concept, not a claim that all characters are already implemented.

CHARACTER	ROLE IN THE CONCEPT
Adaeze	Protagonist; daughter of Ala and the central force seeking to restore balance
Ikenna	A key rival and planned fighter for the initial prototype
Nkiruka	Fighter whose abilities can reveal threats hidden in darkness
Ngozi	Playable fighter in the planned full roster
Ijele	A dramatic fighter drawing on masquerade-inspired spectacle
Ezinne Idemmili	A character associated with the Idemmili lake-shrine setting
Dibịa Okoro	A diviner/healer-inspired fighter
Ekwensu	A dangerous, bargain-driven fighter with risk/reward mechanics
Ogbunabali	Sub-boss designed around attacks emerging from darkness
Eze Efu, the Hollow King	Final boss; the Market Clock becomes unstable across multiple phases

Individual movesets, cultural references and visual designs should be refined alongside playtesting and cultural review.

6. STAGES AND ATMOSPHERE

The proposed game includes nine stages designed to make each fight feel connected to a distinct place and mood.

1. **Umuezeala Village Market:** mud-brick stalls, yam heaps and a reactive crowd; the planned prototype stage.
2. **Oath Stone Grove:** a forest clearing where storm and lightning build tension.
3. **Idemmili Lake Shrine:** stepping stones, rippling water and a python sculpture.
4. **Rooftop Night Market:** urban rooftops blending neon light and traditional lanterns.
5. **Ashen Savannah**: burnt grassland whose light changes with the Market Clock.
6. **Mmọnwụ Festival Ground:** masquerade performers and drummers energise the arena.
7. **Ama-Ụwa, the Great Market:** a crossroads tournament space marked by banners for each day.
8. **Midnight Forest:** reduced visibility makes sound cues strategically important.
9. **Palace of the Hollow King:** a white-void arena dominated by a vast stone Market Clock.

7. ART DIRECTION

"Uli in motion"

The visual identity is planned around stylised 2D characters, hand-painted textures, bold silhouettes and flowing linework inspired by Uli. Rather than using cultural motifs as decoration alone, the art direction aims to connect patterns, combat effects, interfaces and story moments.

Palette: Deep indigo --- night and water - Camwood red --- earth and life - Gold --- sunlight and authority - Chalk white --- nzu, purity and ritual - Forest green --- growth and counterplay

Visual language: Curved, flowing patterns for effects and interface ornaments - Carved wood grain and carefully researched surface textures - Strong costume colour blocks to keep fighters readable during combat - Uli-shaped impact flashes and painted symbols during special moves - A translucent ancestral figure as part of the planned Chi Awakening effect - Animated mural-inspired transitions for the prologue and epilogue

Production principle: readability comes first. Visual detail should strengthen character identity and combat feedback, not obscure attacks or interface information.

8. Audio direction

Sound is intended to identify the world immediately. The proposed score combines instruments such as **ogene, ekwe, igba, udu and ọja** with contemporary production and Igbo highlife influences.

Planned audio elements include: - Distinct attack, block, impact and special-move cues - Environmental ambience that makes each stage feel inhabited - Character voice performances in Igbo, with English subtitles - Music and sound cues that communicate Market Clock changes - Audio clues for encounters in which visibility is reduced

The final sound palette and pronunciation should be reviewed with knowledgeable musicians, speakers and cultural advisors.

9. Language and cultural responsibility

Ọgụ Anọ is a creative adaptation inspired by Igbo cultural traditions. It is not presented as a definitive account of Igbo religion, history or cosmology. The project intends to distinguish documented cultural references from original fictional characters, plot elements and game mechanics.

The production plan calls for cultural and language review, including review by elders, language lecturers and cultural scholars where possible. The game should credit contributors, correct errors transparently, and avoid treating sacred practices or living communities as interchangeable fantasy props.

The phrase "Onye kwe, chi ya ekwe" is used as the project motto in the current design document. Its translation and contextual use should be confirmed during language review.

10. Proposed technical approach

Area	Current proposal
Engine	Godot 4
Rendering	2D
Primary platform	Android with touch controls
Secondary platform	Windows PC; Steam and itch.io are proposed distribution targets
Input	Touch controls and gamepad support
Design target	Compact builds and early testing on lower-end Android devices
Connectivity	Offline-first design; local multiplayer is a potential direction
Online play	An online prototype is planned for a later milestone, not promised for the contest prototype

These are proposed technical choices. Final implementation, performance and distribution remain subject to development and testing.

11. Contest prototype: the vertical slice

The contest prototype is intentionally smaller than the full vision. It should prove the game's most distinctive ideas in a playable, presentable slice.

Planned prototype scope- Two fighters: **Adaeze and Ikenna** - One stage: **Umuezeala Village Market** - A functional Market Clock - Basic combat UI, including health and Ọfọ meter - Core combat interactions and a focused set of moves - One story cutscene - A short gameplay trailer

What the prototype should demonstrate
1. The game has a recognisable visual identity.
2. The Market Clock creates meaningful tactical decisions.
3. The controls and combat are understandable.
4. The setting feels specific and coherent.
5. The concept can grow into a larger story-driven fighting game.

12. Production roadmap

The source design proposes a 3 months production plan. The following milestone outline describes the intended progression; it is a planning target, not a confirmed delivery schedule.

Milestone	Intended scope
Contest prototype	2 fighters, 1 stage, Market Clock, basic UI, 1 story cutscene and gameplay trailer
Alpha	5 fighters, 5 stages, story chapters 1--5 and an online prototype
Beta	8 fighters, 9 stages, full story, Codex, localisation and balance pass
Launch target	Full game, 4 endings, bosses, achievements and

	storefront materials

Key production risks

- **Scope:** prioritise a polished vertical slice before expanding the roster.
- **Animation workload:** establish reusable rigs and clear limits for move animation.
- **Combat balance:** playtest early and iterate on Market Clock bonuses.
- **Mobile performance:** test on lower-end devices from the beginning.
- **Cultural accuracy:** schedule review checkpoints rather than leaving review until the end.
- **Budget and team capacity:** use milestone-based scope and identify essential collaborators early.

13. Audience and potential impact

The project is designed for: - Players who enjoy 2D fighting games and character mastery - Players in Africa and the diaspora seeking stories shaped by African settings - Fighting-game communities interested in new mechanics and distinctive rosters - Educators and cultural organisations interested in carefully contextualised interactive storytelling

The opportunity is to combine a familiar competitive format with a less commonly explored cultural setting. The project's success will depend on execution: responsive combat, readable visuals, a strong prototype and responsible cultural collaboration.